

THE PATE STATE.

Site Handover & Operations Guide

Everything your team needs to own and run **thepatestate.com** — what it is, how it runs itself, the one job that needs a human every day, and the checklist for transferring full control.

Prepared August 10, 2026 · Isaac Meek · Version 1.0

1 · What You're Receiving

thepatestate.com is a self-running college football site built around Josh's show. It was designed to the specification in the Operations Manual v1.2 (in the repo at `docs/`) with one governing rule: **the site publishes autonomously, except anything in Josh's voice or under Josh's byline — that always waits for a human click.**

- **The Show** — every episode, pulled automatically from YouTube minutes after it publishes.
- **The Notebook** — AI-drafted companion articles for every episode, grounded in the real transcript with Josh's verbatim quotes deep-linked to the video, waiting in an approval queue.
- **The Wire** — an autonomous breaking-news desk that monitors ESPN/CBS/Yahoo feeds every 10 minutes, writes attributed news items, and auto-publishes verified full stories with Josh's real archived takes attached.
- **The Playbook** — a daily 6:00 AM ET email to registered citizens, assembled from real site content.
- **Citizenship** — free registration (magic link or Google) storing fans in your own database.
- **Scores & Schedules** — real FBS schedule data live now; scores flow automatically on gamedays.
- **JP Poll, Pick'em, Playoffs, Recruiting, Tailgate, Store** — designed and built; the interactive engines (voting, picks, brackets) are labeled preseason previews and activate as those features launch with the season.

2 · The Accounts (all clean-slate, all yours)

Every account was created fresh for this project — nothing is entangled with any other business. The root of everything is the Gmail account: it owns or recovers all the others.

SERVICE	IDENTITY / PROJECT	WHAT IT DOES	COST TODAY
Google (root)	the.pate.state@gmail.com	Owns/recovers every account below; Google OAuth login; brand Drive	Free
GitHub	github.com/thepateststate/thepateststate	All site code (85 commits), prompts, manuals, migrations	Free
Vercel	thepateststate-8303	Hosting, deploys on every push, edge caching, env secrets	Free (Hobby)
Cloudflare	thepateststate.com	Domain registration + DNS	~\$10/yr
Sanity	project kuv6jjyo · thepateststate.sanity.studio	CMS: episodes, articles, wire items — and the approval queue	Free
Supabase	project ddzwgmbptcnopqdzvrhl	Citizens database, quote archive, wire dedup, all cron schedules	Free
Anthropic	API workspace	Claude (the AI writing articles, wire stories, email intros)	~\$10–30/mo
Resend	porch@thepateststate.com (verified)	Sends the Playbook email + login links	Free ≤100/day
Black Forest Labs	API account	Generates article hero images (~4¢ each)	~\$2–5/mo
Supadata	API account	Episode transcripts (100/mo free covers current volume)	Free
CollegeFootballData	API key	Real schedules, scores, conferences	Free

Secrets are NOT in this document. All passwords and API keys are delivered separately and securely (password-manager share). Live API keys exist in exactly two places: the repo's untracked `.env.local` file and Vercel's environment settings. If a key ever leaks, rotate it at the issuing service and update both places.

3 · How It Runs Itself

The autonomous clock (all times ET)

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	HUMAN INVOLVED?
Instantly on upload	YouTube pings the site → episode ingested → transcript fetched → Josh's 5–10 biggest quotes archived verbatim → companion article drafted with a generated hero image → approval queue	Approve to publish (5–10 min)
Every 15 min	Backup poll of the channel (catches anything the webhook missed)	No
Every 10 min, 6am–midnight	Wire Desk sweeps national feeds → clusters stories → publishes attributed wire items → big stories (importance ≥7) become full verified articles automatically	No — monitor after the fact
Weekdays 6:00 AM	The Playbook email assembles itself (yesterday's episode + top wire items + the day's ritual) and sends to all citizens	No
Daily 5:00 AM	Episode view counts refresh; most-popular reordering	No
Weekly Mon	YouTube webhook subscription renews itself	No

The one daily human job

Open [thepatestate.sanity.studio](#) → Approval Queue. New AI drafts sit in state *ai-drafted*. Read the draft (5–10 minutes — the quotes are verbatim from the transcript and deep-linked, so spot-checking is fast). Fix anything you want, then change **workflowState** → **approved**. The article publishes to the live site within a minute, with its hero image, video embeds, and SEO fields already in place.

Drafts flagged **lowConfidence** deserve a closer read — it means the transcript was missing or a quote couldn't be verified word-for-word.

Editorial rules already enforced in software

- **Bylines:** "Josh Pate" appears only on content Josh wrote or approved. AI staff coverage is bylined "The Pate State Staff" (third-person). Autonomous news is "The Wire Desk" with an AI disclosure on every story.
- **Quotes:** anything inside quotation marks is machine-verified as a word-for-word transcript match. The system physically cannot publish an invented Josh quote.
- **Wire sourcing:** every story names its source in sentence one, passes an independent AI fact-check against the sources, and blocks a banned-inference list (no motive speculation, no health prognosis, no "sources tell The Pate State"). Injury/legal stories use a sober register with zero humor.
- **Corrections:** never edit facts silently — strike through and append a timestamped correction.
- The full standards live in the repo: `prompts/voice-manual.md` and `prompts/wire-desk-manual.md` (Josh's own documents, implemented as written).

4 · Architecture (for whoever inherits the code)

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	NOTES
Framework	Next.js 16 (App Router, TypeScript) on Vercel	Static + ISR; pushes to <code>main</code> auto-deploy
CMS	Sanity (hosted Studio)	Types: episode, article, wireItem, wireStory; webhook publishes approved articles
Database	Supabase Postgres	citizens (RLS-locked), josh_quotes (120+ verbatim quotes), wire_clusters; pg_cron drives every schedule
Auth	Supabase Auth	Email magic link + Google OAuth; 30-second signup
AI	Anthropic Claude (claude-sonnet-5)	Structured JSON outputs; all prompts versioned in <code>/prompts</code>
Email	Resend	RFC-8058 one-click unsubscribe; CAN-SPAM address via env var
Images	Black Forest Labs FLUX API	Article heroes auto-generated; brand imagery in <code>public/img</code>
Transcripts	Supadata API (+ direct YouTube fallback)	Word-timestamped; feeds quotes + articles
Sports data	CollegeFootballData API	Schedules live; scores auto-flow on gamedays

Tests: 103 unit tests (`npm test`). Local dev: `npm install && npm run dev` with `.env.local` present. Every pipeline is fail-soft: if an external service is down, the site serves its last good state rather than erroring.

Runbook — the five most likely situations

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
A wire story is wrong	Open Studio → Wire Story → edit with a strikethrough + timestamped correction line, or unpublish (delete) to retract. The story's sources are listed on every item.
Pause ALL wire publishing	Supabase dashboard → Database → Extensions → <code>pg_cron</code> → unschedule <code>wire-monitor</code> (or ask a developer to <code>run select cron.unschedule('wire-monitor')</code>).
An article draft is bad	Just leave it un-approved (nothing publishes without the click), or delete it in Studio.
Stop the daily email	Unschedule <code>send-playbook</code> the same way as the wire, or remove <code>RESEND_API_KEY</code> from Vercel env.
Site looks broken after a code change	Vercel dashboard → Deployments → promote the previous deployment (instant rollback).

5 · Monthly Cost Summary

LINE	CURRENT SPEND	SCALES WITH
Anthropic API (articles + wire + email intros)	~\$10-30	News volume; in-season expect the top of that range
Image generation (heroes)	~\$2-5	~4¢ per article
Domain	~\$1 (≈\$10/yr)	—
Vercel / Sanity / Supabase / Resend / Supadata / CFBD	\$0	Free tiers cover current traffic; first paid upgrades will be Resend (>100 emails/day as citizens grow) and Vercel Pro (~\$20/mo) for team seats
Total	≈ \$15-40/mo	

6 • Transfer Checklist

Do these in order, on a call together if possible. The Gmail root makes most of it simple.

- Hand over **the.pate.state@gmail.com** (password + set YOUR phone as 2FA and recovery). This is the master key — after this step, your team controls recovery for everything.
- Change the Gmail password and add 2FA immediately.
- Receive the password-manager share with all service passwords + API keys (never email these).
- GitHub: accept owner invite to the **thepatestate** org; remove Isaac when comfortable.
- Vercel: accept team ownership transfer; verify env variables are intact (Settings → Environment Variables).
- Cloudflare: confirm domain + DNS access; update billing card for the annual renewal.
- Sanity: accept admin invite to org **orA5oNKiO**; add Josh/producer as Studio editors (they only ever need the Studio, not the code). *Note: a second, empty Sanity account with a typo name ("thepatestatee") exists — delete it.*
- Supabase, Anthropic, Resend, BFL, Supadata, CFBD: log in via the Gmail root or transferred passwords; update billing cards where applicable (Anthropic and BFL hold small credit balances).
- Rotate the Supabase database password and the Sanity write token after transfer (both were used during the build; rotating voids any residual exposure). A developer does this in ~15 minutes: change in Supabase/Sanity dashboards → update `.env.local` + Vercel env → redeploy.
- Update `PLAYBOOK_POSTAL_ADDRESS` in Vercel env to your preferred business mailing address (CAN-SPAM footer).
- Decide who holds the daily approval seat (the §22 "human monitor") and bookmark the Studio on their machine.

7 • What's Live vs. What Activates With the Season

LIVE TODAY	LABELED "PRESEASON PREVIEW" — ACTIVATES IN-SEASON
Show pages (all real videos) · article pipeline + approval queue · Wire Desk (real news now) · Playbook email · citizenship/signup · real Week 1 schedule & slate strip · Josh's published bracket article · quote archive (120+ takes) · store links to patestatematerial.com	JP Poll voting/tabulation · Porch Pick'em grading + pros board harvesting · Bracket Challenge · live in-game scoreboard refresh · Josh's real Watch Order (replaces demo Top-10 list) · recruiting data sync · team pages ×136

Recommended next steps for your team: (1) publish 2–3 articles from the queue this week so launch day isn't empty; (2) send Josh's real Week 1 Watch Order to replace the demo list; (3) supply real tailgate photography for the guide tiles; (4) create @ThePateState social handles if you want the site auto-posting wire headlines (the hook is built, just needs accounts); (5) an X/Twitter API subscription is the single biggest upgrade for breaking-news speed if you want the Wire to beat the big sites consistently.

8 • Key Links

Site	<code>https://thepatestate.com</code>
Approval queue (Studio)	<code>https://thepatestate.sanity.studio</code>
Code	<code>https://github.com/thepatestate/thepatestate</code>
Hosting	<code>https://vercel.com</code> (team <code>thepatestate-8303</code>)
Database	<code>https://supabase.com/dashboard</code> (project <code>ddzwgmbptcnopqdzvrl</code>)
Ops manual v1.2	repo: <code>docs/pate-state-operations-manual.md</code>
Voice + Wire manuals	repo: <code>prompts/voice-manual.md</code> · <code>prompts/wire-desk-manual.md</code>

Prepared by Isaac Meek with the site's build history · August 10, 2026 · The Pate State v1 · Questions during transition: Isaac remains available for a handover call and 30 days of email support.